

D826

Organizational Technology Strategy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A community bank whose mission is “personal service for local families” has these IT proposals: a blockchain pilot the architects are excited about, a mobile app for faster loan decisions for local customers, and a new data center with marble floors. Which should rank first?

- A. The mobile loan app, because it directly advances service to local families.
- B. The blockchain pilot, because the architects are excited.
- C. All three equally.
- D. The data center, because infrastructure always comes first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An online retailer with a quirky mascot wins customers with a recommendation engine its competitors cannot match. It also runs standard email and payroll. The CFO, who joined from a manufacturer, wants to cut IT spending evenly across all systems. What is the better approach?

- A. Invest heavily in custom payroll.
- B. Cut all systems evenly.
- C. Follow the approach used at the CFO’s old manufacturer.
- D. Protect investment in the recommendation engine and standardize email and payroll at low cost.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A furniture maker whose founder was a carpenter wants to map its value chain. Where does its human resources department, which recruits skilled woodworkers, belong?

- A. Primary activity (operations), since woodworkers build the furniture.
- B. Not part of the value chain.
- C. Support activity (human resource management)
- D. Primary activity (marketing and sales)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is a primary activity in the value chain?

- A. Delivering finished orders to customers.
- B. Researching new product materials.
- C. Purchasing office supplies.
- D. Maintaining the accounting system.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A hospital's IT department, which recently moved to a new building, tracks the percentage of IT staff who earned a cloud certification this year. In which balanced scorecard perspective does this metric belong?

- A. Learning and growth
- B. Financial
- C. Internal business process
- D. Customer

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company wants a balanced scorecard metric in the customer perspective. Which fits?

- A. Average ticket resolution time.
- B. Net Promoter Score from users of its services.
- C. Hours of staff training.
- D. Return on IT investment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A sales team at a boat dealer with a lakeside showroom proposes a CRM that costs \$400,000 in total over three years and is expected to produce \$520,000 in added profit over the same period. What is the ROI?

- A. \$120,000
- B. 30%
- C. 130%
- D. 23%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project will cost \$200,000. Leadership requires a 25% ROI. What total benefit must the project produce?

- A.** \$50,000
- B.** \$225,000
- C.** \$160,000
- D.** \$250,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A mid-size law firm, known for its striking office art, needs time-and-expense tracking that works much like every other firm's. Its IT lead wants to build a custom system because "we're unique." What is the better choice?

- A.** Always build, because custom is higher quality.
- B.** Build custom so it fits the firm exactly.
- C.** Buy or subscribe to a proven package, since the need is standard.
- D.** Build it to match the firm's office style.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A manufacturer with a 90-year history wants a single system that links purchasing, inventory, production scheduling, and the general ledger. Its CEO prefers cloud products. Which type of system fits?

- A.** CRM
- B.** HRIS
- C.** A spreadsheet per department
- D.** ERP

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A school district compares systems. System A costs \$100,000 to buy, \$50,000 to implement, and \$35,000 a year in maintenance and support. The vendor's demo was held in a new auditorium. What is System A's five-year total cost of ownership?

- A.** \$100,000
- B.** \$185,000
- C.** \$325,000
- D.** \$275,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Option A costs \$300,000 upfront plus \$10,000 a year. Option B is a subscription at \$60,000 a year with no upfront cost. Over five years, which has the lower TCO?

- A.** They are equal.
- B.** Option B, at \$300,000 vs. \$350,000.
- C.** Option A, because its yearly cost is lower.
- D.** Option A, at \$310,000 vs. \$300,000.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A community bank whose mission is “personal service for local families” has these IT proposals: a blockchain pilot the architects are excited about, a mobile app for faster loan decisions for local customers, and a new data center ~~with marble floors~~. Which should rank first?

Target word: alignment **Decides:** Mission: serve local families.

A	Correct	Ranks by fit with mission and strategy.
B	Inverted operation	Tech interest first, business reason later.
C	Dropped element	Skips prioritization.
D	Absolute language	Infrastructure is ranked by the strategy it serves.

2. Answer D Concept 2

An online retailer ~~with a quirky mascot~~ wins customers with a recommendation engine its competitors cannot match. It also runs standard email and payroll. The CFO, ~~who joined from a manufacturer~~, wants to cut IT spending evenly across all systems. What is the better approach?

Target word: differentiate vs. commoditize **Decides:** The recommendation engine is the differentiator.

A	Inverted operation	Gold-plates a commodity.
B	Dropped element	Ignores which systems create advantage.
C	Camouflage	A different business model.
D	Correct	Invest where IT differentiates; minimize commodity cost.

3. Answer C Concept 3

A furniture maker ~~whose founder was a carpenter~~ wants to map its value chain. Where does its human resources department, which recruits skilled woodworkers, belong?

Target word: value chain classification **Decides:** HR is a support activity.

A	Adjacent category	The workers are in operations; recruiting them is support.
B	Absolute language	HR is a named support activity.
C	Correct	HR enables primary activities but does not create the product itself.
D	Confusion set	HR does not sell products.

4. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Which activity is a primary activity in the value chain?

Target word: reverse identification **Decides:** Delivery to customers is outbound logistics.

A	Correct	Outbound logistics is primary.
B	Adjacent category	Technology development is support.
C	Confusion set	Procurement is support.
D	Inverted operation	Firm infrastructure is support.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A hospital's IT department, ~~which recently moved to a new building,~~ tracks the percentage of IT staff who earned a cloud certification this year. In which balanced scorecard perspective does this metric belong?

Target word: scorecard perspective **Decides:** Staff skills = learning and growth.

A	Correct	Tracks people and capability building.
B	Adjacent category	Training has costs, but the metric measures capability.
C	Confusion set	Covers process efficiency and quality, not staff skills.
D	Confusion set	Covers satisfaction and retention of those served.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A company wants a balanced scorecard metric in the customer perspective. Which fits?

Target word: reverse: pick metric for perspective **Decides:** Customer satisfaction/retention.

A	Confusion set	An internal process metric.
B	Correct	Measures customer perception.
C	Inverted operation	Learning and growth.
D	Adjacent category	Financial.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A sales team at a boat dealer ~~with a lakeside showroom~~ proposes a CRM that costs \$400,000 in total over three years and is expected to produce \$520,000 in added profit over the same period. What is the ROI?

Target word: ROI **Decides:** $(520 - 400) / 400$.

A	Adjacent category	Net benefit, not the ROI ratio.
B	Correct	$\$120,000 / \$400,000 = 30\%$.
C	Confusion set	Benefit / cost without subtracting cost.
D	Inverted operation	Divides by benefit $(\$120,000 / \$520,000)$.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A project will cost \$200,000. Leadership requires a 25% ROI. What total benefit must the project produce?

Target word: solve for benefit **Decides:** $\text{Benefit} = \text{cost} \times (1 + \text{ROI})$.

A	Dropped element	Net gain only; leaves out recovering the cost.
B	Wrong stem number	Adds 25 as thousands instead of 25%.
C	Inverted operation	Reduces cost by 20% instead of adding the return.
D	Correct	$\$200,000 \times 1.25 = \$250,000$.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A mid-size law firm, ~~known for its striking office art,~~ needs time-and-expense tracking that works much like every other firm's. Its IT lead wants to build a custom system because "we're unique." What is the better choice?

Target word: build vs. buy **Decides:** Commodity capability.

A	Absolute language	Custom adds cost and maintenance burden.
B	Inverted operation	High cost for a standard need.
C	Correct	Buy commodity; build only differentiators.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the decision.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A manufacturer ~~with a 90-year history,~~ wants a single system that links purchasing, inventory, production scheduling, and the general ledger. ~~Its CEO prefers cloud products.~~ Which type of system fits?

Target word: match system to need **Decides:** Integrated finance, supply chain, operations.

A	Confusion set	Supports marketing, sales, and service.
B	Confusion set	Supports HR functions.
C	Inverted operation	The opposite of integration.
D	Correct	Integrates finance, supply chain, and operations.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A school district compares systems. System A costs \$100,000 to buy, \$50,000 to implement, and \$35,000 a year in maintenance and support. ~~The vendor's demo was held in a new auditorium.~~ What is System A's five-year total cost of ownership?

Target word: TCO **Decides:** $100 + 50 + 5 \times 35$.

A	Dropped element	Purchase price only.
B	Wrong stem number	Counts only one year of maintenance.
C	Correct	$\$100,000 + \$50,000 + \$175,000 = \$325,000$.
D	Confusion set	Leaves out implementation.

12. Answer B Concept 8 • transfer

Option A costs \$300,000 upfront plus \$10,000 a year. Option B is a subscription at \$60,000 a year with no upfront cost. Over five years, which has the lower TCO?

Target word: compare TCO **Decides:** $A = \$350,000$; $B = \$300,000$.

A	Confusion set	Totals differ by \$50,000.
B	Correct	$A: \$300,000 + \$50,000$; $B: 5 \times \$60,000$.
C	Dropped element	Ignores the upfront cost.
D	Wrong stem number	Counts only one year of A's annual cost.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	IT strategy follows business strategy	Technology initiatives are chosen and ranked by how well they advance the organization's mission and strategic goals.	Setting IT priorities by technical interest or trend, then seeking a business reason.	A project list with no link to stated business goals.
2	Differentiation vs. commodity IT	Invest to differentiate where technology creates competitive advantage; standardize and minimize cost where IT is a commodity.	Treating all IT as a cost to cut, or gold-plating commodity systems.	Whether a system is how the firm wins customers or just keeps the lights on.
3	Primary vs. support activities (value chain)	Primary activities (inbound logistics, operations, outbound logistics, marketing and sales, service) create and deliver the product; support activities (firm infrastructure, HR, technology development, procurement) enable them.	Classifying HR or R&D as primary because they are important.	An activity that must be sorted into the value chain.
4	Balanced scorecard perspectives	The balanced scorecard tracks financial, customer, internal business process, and learning and growth perspectives.	Putting employee training under internal process, or measuring only financials.	A metric that must be placed in one perspective.
5	ROI in the business case	$ROI = (\text{total benefit} - \text{total cost}) / \text{total cost}$.	Dividing by benefit instead of cost, or reporting net benefit as the ROI.	Benefit and cost totals for one initiative.
6	Build vs. buy	Buy or subscribe for standard capabilities; build when the capability is a core differentiator that packages cannot provide.	Building custom software for commodity needs because "we're unique."	A capability many firms need in the same way.
7	Matching systems to business functions	CRM supports marketing, sales, and service; HRIS supports human resources; ERP integrates finance, accounting, supply chain, and operations; PLM supports R&D product development.	Mixing up CRM and ERP, or assigning HR needs to CRM.	A function named with a problem to solve.
8	Total cost of ownership	TCO includes acquisition plus implementation, maintenance, support, training, and operating costs over the system's life.	Comparing only purchase prices.	Upfront and recurring costs over several years.

Course scope (public description): Organizational Technology Strategy is designed to bridge the gap between information technology and business strategies. This course goes beyond traditional information technology (IT) management and focuses on integrating IT solutions with core business objectives. Learners delve into the nuances of aligning technology initiatives with a company's mission and explore how technology can enhance and support functions like marketing, human resources, accounting, research and development, and operations.